

POLICY HANDBOOK

M E R I T

“A **positive** work
environment
will help you
to **accomplish**
your career goals.”

Welcome to **#Lifeatmerit**

SL.
NO.

POLICY

- 1** Policy on Code of Conduct
- 2** Policy on Dress Code
- 3** Policy on Leave
- 4** Policy on Performance Management System
- 5** Policy on Medical & Accidental Insurance
- 6** Policy on Internal Job Posting
- 7** Policy on Remote Location Working
- 8** POSH
- 9** Disciplinary Policy
- 10** Information Security Related Policy
- 11** Policy on Employee Referral
- 12** Policy on Separation

TABLE OF CONTENTS

1

Policy on Code of Conduct

The Code of Conduct is designed to promote integrity, transparency, and accountability in all business operations.

Establish clear expectations for ethical behaviour and decision-making.

Ensure compliance with applicable laws and regulations in India and globally.

This policy applies to all employees (Full Time, Interns, Apprentice, Direct Contractors, Third Party Contractors), including those based in Chennai, Mumbai, and any other locations where the company operates.

CODE OF CONDUCT CLASSIFICATION SPECTRUM

Personal Conduct

- Compliance with Laws and Regulations
- Respect and Inclusion
- Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH)
- Substance Abuse
- Relatives in the Workplace
- Fraud

Conduct at work

- Integrity and Ethical Behaviour
- Confidentiality and Data Security
- Performance and Accountability
- Professional Conduct
- Health, Safety, and Environment
- Misuse or Damage of Company Assets
- Disciplinary Actions

Interface with External World

- Use of Brand and Third-Party Representation
- Conflict of Interest
- Media & Communications
- Anti Bribery and Anti-Corruption
- Reporting Violations
- Expenses and Claims
- Secondary Employment
- Equality and Diversity Principles

2

Policy on Dress Code

MEN

✓	Dos	Don'ts	✗
	Formal pants, Denim pants & trousers.	Transparent or glittery clothes.	
	Long / half sleeved collared shirts.	Sweatpants, and shorts of any kind.	
	Sweatshirts & T shirts.	Pictures / Phrases / captions on clothes that are defamatory or derogatory or may cause offence are prohibited.	
	Shoes are mandatory	Clothes with other company logos are not allowed. This excludes clothing brands (e.g. Arrow, Nike, Puma etc.)	
	Well-groomed facial hair.	Slippers / Floaters are strictly avoided.	



WOMEN

✓	Dos	Don'ts	✗
	Formal pants and Denim	Short skirts, miniskirts, sundresses. Strappy, halter neck dresses with low cuts and made of semi-transparent or transparent fabric.	
	Formal skirts should be below knee length with slits that fall below the knee.	Body-fitting dresses that look inappropriate as work wear.	
	Shirts & formal sleeveless tops, T-Shirts, casual shirts, dress shirts, sweaters, tops, golf-type shirts, and Turtlenecks are acceptable.	Pictures / Phrases / captions on clothes that are defamatory or derogatory are prohibited.	
	Indian wear – Sarees & Churidar-Kurta.	Clothes with other company logos are not allowed. This excludes clothing brands (e.g. – Arrow, Nike, Puma etc.) Sweatshirts & tops with bare shoulders are inappropriate attire for work	



3

Policy on Leave

LEAVE POLICY

SUN		2	8	14	20	26
MON		3	9	15	21	27
THU		4	10	16	22	28
WED		5	11	17	23	29
FRI		6	12	18	24	30
SAT	1	7	13	19	25	31

Leave Type	Eligibility Per Annum	Carry Forward
Casual Leave	12 Days	NA
Sick Leave	8 Days	NA
Earned Leave	16 Days	6 Days
Paternity Leave	5 Days	NA
Maternity Leave	6 Months	NA
Miscarriage Leave	6 Weeks	NA
Adoption / Surrogacy Leave*	12 Weeks	NA
ESIC Leave	As per ESIC act	NA

Below is the time line for applying leave.

If applying for	Apply before:
1 day	1 day
2 to 4 days	3 days
5 days or more	10 days

4

Policy on Performance Management System

Scope: This policy applies to all full-time Merit employees across all divisions and levels, excluding interns and direct contract or third-party employees unless specifically included by the management.

Performance Review Cycle:

Merit conducts three performance review cycles: **Monthly, Quarterly, and Annual.**

Monthly & Quarterly Reviews: Based on job role and level.

Annual Review: Applies to all full-time employees.



New Employees will be aligned to the review cycle as per the frequency defined for their role and level.

Monthly Cycle: Eligible from the month following completion of three (3) months of service.

Quarterly Cycle: Eligible if employed for at least 50% of the review period (half of the quarter).

Note: Only full-time employees who joined Merit on or before 30th September of the appraisal period are eligible for the annual performance appraisal.

Performance Review Process:

The following process applies all performance review cycles:

- Self-Review** Employees evaluate their performance and contributions for the review period, providing self-assessed ratings for each assigned objective.
- 1-2-1 Discussion** The employee and reporting manager conduct a structured one-on-one discussion to review achievements, challenges, development needs, and key learnings.
- Manager Review** After the discussion, the manager finalizes and submits performance ratings in the HR Information System (HRIS).
- Acknowledgment** Once the review window closes, employees must acknowledge the final ratings assigned by their managers to formally complete the process.

Performance Evaluation Rating Scale:

Merit uses a 4-point rating scale to evaluate employees' performance against set objectives:

**Did Not Meet
Expectations**

**Meets
Expectations**

**Exceeds
Expectations**

**Outstanding
Performance**

Performance Improvement Program:

Merit maintains a high-performance culture through a structured that supports employees in improving their performance.

Performance Improvement Program (PIP)

Employees who receive a **"Did Not Meet Expectations"** rating for two consecutive months/quarters or three times within a six-month period will be placed on a PIP.

The HR Business Partner (HRBP) and reporting manager will provide necessary guidance, support, and training throughout the program.



Medical Insurance

All employees are covered under the medical insurance scheme. Direct consultants also covered under the medical insurance

The policy covers hospitalization for illness as well as accidents

The policy extends coverage to Merit employees and direct consultants, along with their spouse and up to two children. It also includes coverage for LGBTQ partners and live-in partners.

The insurance covers a Maternity Benefit

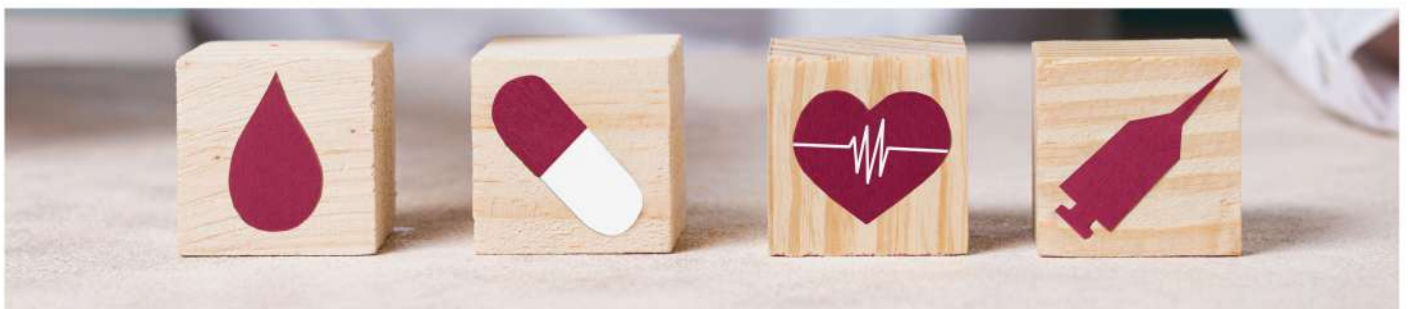
- Normal Delivery: up to Rs.75,000/-
- C-section Delivery: up to Rs. 1,00,000/-

The maximum limit for Medical insurance coverage is Rs. 3,00,000/-.

Group Personal Accident

All employees (not their families) are covered under the Group Personal Accident. Direct consultants are also covered under this policy.

The maximum limit for accidental insurance coverage is Rs. 5,00,000/-.



6

Policy on Internal Job Posting



This policy applies to all full-time employees at Merit Data and Technology Private Limited, across all departments and locations within India

Eligibility Criteria

- Minimum of 12 months in their current role
- Minimum performance rating of "Meets Expectations" or above in the last 12 months
- Must not have had any disciplinary actions
- The reporting manager will be informed about the application
- Employees must align with the company's core values.

Re-Application Rules

- Employees who are not selected through the IJP process must wait for a period of 6 months
- Employees withdrawing from the IJP process post shortlisting without valid reason may also be subject to a 12-months cooling-off period

APPLICATION & SELECTION PROCESS

- **APPLICATION SUBMISSION** Employees must submit their application through the official channel within the posted deadline.
- **ASSESSMENT PROCESS** Based on the role level, the selection process may include: Technical or Functional Assessments, Case Studies or Presentations, Behavioural Assessments (as applicable)
- **INTERVIEW PROCESS** Shortlisted candidates are shortlisted based on the Assessment score, Managerial Interview / Panel Interview (for mid to senior-level roles) including cross functional stakeholders or business leaders as appropriate
- **FINAL DECISION** Post-evaluation the HRBP will share the feedback to the employee's reporting manager

ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES:



7

Policy on Remote Location Working



STANDARD WORK HOURS

Employees are expected to adhere to their regular work schedule while working remotely and ensure the required daily working hours are completed



AVAILABILITY

Employees must be available during their defined working hours for communication, meetings, and collaboration. Any changes to availability should be communicated to the reporting manager in advance. During the shift hours employees will need to be responsive within a reasonable time including employees working for clients and are on client VPN. If there is no response to MS Teams chat within 2 hours, phone calls within 1.5 hours or email within 4 hours, the employee will be marked half day LOP. Failure to comply with this will lead to disciplinary action including termination of employment



BREAKS

Employees should take breaks in line with company policies, including lunch.



COMMUNICATION TOOLS

Employees must remain accessible via company-approved communication tools (e.g., email, Microsoft Teams) during working hours and respond to work-related queries in a timely manner.



MEETING ATTENDANCE

Employees are required to attend all scheduled virtual meetings (including Client & Team meetings) unless excused by the reporting manager. During these meetings, the employee must turn on their camera on Microsoft Teams.

All employees are expected to uphold the highest standards of ethical conduct at the workplace and in all their interactions with business stakeholders. This means that employees have a responsibility to:

- Treat each other with dignity and respect;
- Follow the letter and spirit of the law;
- Refrain from any unwelcome behaviour that has sexual connotation (of sexual nature);
- Refrain from creating hostile atmosphere at workplace; and
- Report sexual harassment experienced and/or witnessed to appropriate authorities and abide by the complaint handling procedure of the company.

Please refer mKonnnect page for details of POSH committee members.

For any complaints you may write to

posh@meritgroup.co.uk



9

Disciplinary Policy

Merit's discipline policy and procedures are designed to provide a structured corrective action process in conjunction with other company policies to improve and prevent a recurrence of undesirable employee behaviour and to address performance issues

DISCIPLINE HANDLING MATRIX



ATTENDANCE



Excessive unplanned leave and/or tardiness issues,
Sleeping on the job, not attending meetings

Unauthorized leave

Leaving the work premise during work hours without
obtaining permission from the supervisor

Not returning to work following a break/lunch period

Walking out of work without
explanation or permission

Violation

1st

2nd

3rd

4th

VW

WW/VW

WW/T

T

VW

WW

T

VW

WW

WW

T

VW

WW

WW/T

T

WW

T



BEHAVIOUR

	Violation			
	1st	2nd	3rd	4th
Inappropriate computer use, Inappropriate access, Sharing Password, Excessive personal use	VW	WW	T	
Pornography, Data Breach, Data Theft	T			
Unauthorized and wilful destruction of property	WW/T	T		
Destruction of property	T			
Insubordination	VW	WW	T	
Violent behaviour	WW	T		
Abusive/profane language	WW	WW	T	
Bullying	WW/T	T		



PERFORMANCE

	Violation			
	1st	2nd	3rd	4th
Behaviour violating Merit Values - ASPIRE	VW	WW	WW/T	T
Gross negligence resulting in safety hazards	WW	WW		
Discrimination of any kind	WW	T		
Sexual Harassment	WW/T	T		
Possession of lethal weapon on campus in violation	WW/T	T		
Dishonesty, Fraud, and Conflicts of Interest	WW/T	T		
Unfavourable BGV	WW/T	T		
False request for reimbursement, or falsification of any reimbursement claims	WW/T	T		
Working unauthorized time	VW	VW/WW	WW	T
Sleeping on the job	VW	VW/WW	WW/T	T
Not meeting performance goals	VW	PIP	T	T
Negligence	VW/WW	WW/T	T	
Incompetence/lack of skills necessary to perform the job	C *	WW	T	
Failure to meet any conditions of employment	WW/VW	S	T	
Committing a misdemeanour/felony related to position	WW/T	S/T	T	
Failure to report sexual misconduct or gender discrimination	WW	S/T	T	

* counselling



INFORMATION SECURITY & CLIENT POACHING

	Violation			
	1st	2nd	3rd	4th
Stealing Company owned information	T			
Wilful disclosure of Company Information	T			
Wilful destruction of Company owned information	T			
Client Poaching	T			

10

Information Security Related Policy



11

Policy on Employee Referral

This policy is applicable to all employees up to L7 except employees in the HR department.

Only the profiles received in the email jobs@meritgroup.co.uk will be screened and if shortlisted will be called for an interview.

This policy is applicable to candidates who have not worked or attended any interview in Merit in the last 6 months.

Referral Amount & Pay-out Terms

S. NO.	Positions	Level	Amount	Pay-Out after (days)	Processing Date	Payout Date
1	Voice	L1 - L4	10,000	120	25th of Every month	Salary Credit Date
2	Data	L1 - L4	3,000	120		
3	Data & Voice - Part time	L1 - L4	2,000	120		
4	Support	L1 - L4	5,000	120		
5	IT Software	L1 - L7	20,000	180		
6	Management	L5 & above	15,000	180		

Note: The above referral program will not be applicable to any contract positions.

12

Policy on Separation

All employees are expected to give notice of resignation as per the notice period mentioned in their employment contract.

Level	Tenure	Notice Period
All Levels	Under Probation	30 days
L1 - L4	Confirmed Employees	60 days
L5+ (includes all IT Employees,Business Analysts even if they are below L5)	Tenure more than 6 months	90 days

- **Failure to provide appropriate written notice may result in the employee being considered ineligible for future employment at Merit.** If Merit must terminate an employee's employment for reasons other than those mentioned under the heading "Immediate discharge or Termination", the employee will be given the same amount of notice that is expected of that employee for resignation.
- If an employee is unable to serve their notice period for whatever reason, the discretion to waive the notice period lies with the Department Head. However, in such cases, the employee will have to pay for the short fall in notice period. If the employee is not paying for the short fall in notice period, then the respective Division Head should approve the notice waiver.
- Any unapproved / uninformed absence during the notice period might result in the salary being put on hold till the issue is resolved.

General Note: For comprehensive information, please refer to the policy available on the internal portal (mKonnnect) or within PeopleStrong.

SOCIAL
REACH

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www.meritdata-tech.com